01 / OPERATING MODEL

Start with the work the organisation would need to do.

PROPOSED INTERFACE

1 / owner → author

AUTHORITY BOUNDARY

5 interfaces, 4 roles; no appointments or delegated authority.



Figure 1 / fictional illustration, not evidence / curated image source in provenance.json

CAPABILITY / INTERFACE / RESPONSIBILITY

Intent

Coordinate a bounded source-based explanation task.

Model scope

4 conceptual roles and 5 proposed interfaces.

Authority boundary

No real appointments or delegated powers.

What must remain clear when the work moves to another role?

Source Desk is a fictional concept for coordinating source-based explanations. Its operating-model question is how a defined task could move between roles without losing context or responsibility.

An organisation chart alone cannot answer that question. This proposal examines capabilities, interfaces and review conditions. It establishes no actual team, appointments, operating authority or service commitments.

Organisational intent

The model uses four functional roles and five proposed interfaces. Keep each responsibility linked to the relevant task rather than assuming that a title grants permission.

02 / OPERATING MODEL

Trace a value flow that can return for clarification.

PROPOSED INTERFACE

2 / author → coordinator

AUTHORITY BOUNDARY

5 interfaces, 4 roles; no appointments or delegated authority.



Figure 1 / fictional illustration, not evidence / curated image source in provenance.json

CAPABILITY / INTERFACE / RESPONSIBILITY

Start

Owner supplies a scoped brief to the author.

Review path

Draft, source-status note and review question.

Return

Revised explanation goes back for a scope check.

Where should an unresolved meaning return rather than disappear?

The proposed flow moves from a scoped brief to a draft, a source-status note, a review question and a revised explanation. The final handoff returns to the owner for another scope check.

Return paths matter because review can create a question rather than an approval. The five interfaces are planning assumptions, not observed work or a guarantee that the process fits a real organisation.

Value-flow loop

Each output becomes the next interface’s input. This continuity makes the model inspectable without claiming that any actual handoff has happened.

03 / OPERATING MODEL

Map capabilities before assigning people.

PROPOSED INTERFACE

3 / coordinator → reviewer

AUTHORITY BOUNDARY

5 interfaces, 4 roles; no appointments or delegated authority.



Figure 2 / fictional illustration, not evidence / curated image source in provenance.json

CAPABILITY / INTERFACE / RESPONSIBILITY

Intake / explanation

Clarify the task and draft its meaning.

Coordination / review

Preserve source status and inspect the question.

Revision

Explain a change and return unresolved conditions.

Which capability is assumed but not actually established?

The work needs intake, explanation, source coordination, review and revision capabilities. A capability describes something the proposed system must be able to do, not a named person or a software feature.

One person might hold several roles in a real setting, but relevant responsibility and review boundaries must remain distinguishable. The model supplies no headcount, skill assessment or hiring plan.

Capability map

Ask what artifact makes each capability visible and what information it needs from another role. Do not treat a list of capabilities as evidence that they are available.

04 / OPERATING MODEL

Define interfaces as agreements about work.

PROPOSED INTERFACE

4 / reviewer → author

AUTHORITY BOUNDARY

5 interfaces, 4 roles; no appointments or delegated authority.



Figure 2 / fictional illustration, not evidence / curated image source in provenance.json

CAPABILITY / INTERFACE / RESPONSIBILITY

Sender / receiver

A functional handoff, not a named appointment.

Artifact / question

Identify the version and requested next review.

Boundary

Receipt does not imply approval or delegated authority.

What would let the receiver know what has and has not been checked?

An interface should name the sender, receiver, input, expected output and unresolved condition. A transfer of a file is not automatically a transfer of understanding or authority.

The source register proposes owner to author, author to coordinator, coordinator to reviewer, reviewer to author and author to owner. No actual recipient, deadline or service agreement is supplied.

Responsibility interface

Use an explicit receiving question to expose a gap. Received should not mean verified unless that meaning is actually agreed and supported.

05 / OPERATING MODEL

Carry context with the information.

PROPOSED INTERFACE

5 / author → owner

AUTHORITY BOUNDARY

5 interfaces, 4 roles; no appointments or delegated authority.



Figure 3 / fictional illustration, not evidence / curated image source in provenance.json

CAPABILITY / INTERFACE / RESPONSIBILITY

Working question

Why this explanation is being prepared.

Source status

What is attributable and what remains unresolved.

Version

Which artifact the next role is actually reviewing.

Which piece of context would change how the next role interprets the draft?

A draft should travel with its working question, source status and relevant version. If a condition is unresolved, keep it next to the claim rather than only in an unrelated message.

The operating model describes information needs, not an implemented system or permission to share material. Real access, retention and source-use arrangements require appropriate decisions in the actual setting.

Information-flow rule

A source-status note can say that a source is missing. It must not make a gap appear resolved just to produce a complete-looking handoff.

06 / OPERATING MODEL

Separate a proposal from delegated authority.

PROPOSED INTERFACE

1 / owner → author

AUTHORITY BOUNDARY

5 interfaces, 4 roles; no appointments or delegated authority.



Figure 3 / fictional illustration, not evidence / curated image source in provenance.json

CAPABILITY / INTERFACE / RESPONSIBILITY

Scope decision

Who can define or change the task?

Review decision

Who can judge the relevant claim and its evidence?

Release decision

Who can authorise the actual use or publication?

Which decision needs a real authority that this document cannot provide?

The owner could define the task scope, the reviewer could inspect within an agreed remit and the author could revise the explanation. These are proposed responsibilities, not granted decision rights.

A real operating arrangement must establish who can approve, reject, refer or publish in the relevant context. Do not infer permission from a role label or from completion of a review worksheet.

Decision-right questions

The source register marks all delegation as not granted. This is a planning boundary, not an assessment of an actual organisation’s governance.

07 / OPERATING MODEL

Allocate resources to capabilities, not just boxes.

PROPOSED INTERFACE

2 / author → coordinator

AUTHORITY BOUNDARY

5 interfaces, 4 roles; no appointments or delegated authority.



Figure 4 / fictional illustration, not evidence / curated image source in provenance.json

CAPABILITY / INTERFACE / RESPONSIBILITY

Time

Preparation, handoff, review and revision all need attention.

Information

Relevant source context must be appropriately available.

Capability

No actual staff availability or budget established.

Which interface could become constrained even if drafting capacity increased?

A proposed system needs time, suitable source access and appropriate review capability. Resource planning should consider the work at the interfaces, not only the visible production step.

No staffing levels, budget, workload or service duration are supplied. A role’s presence on the map does not establish its availability or imply that coordination and revision have no cost.

Resource questions

Inspect shared constraints and supporting work before proposing commitments. A real allocation needs appropriate responsibility and relevant information.

08 / OPERATING MODEL

Choose a review rhythm for a defined purpose.

PROPOSED INTERFACE

3 / coordinator → reviewer

AUTHORITY BOUNDARY

5 interfaces, 4 roles; no appointments or delegated authority.



Figure 4 / fictional illustration, not evidence / curated image source in provenance.json

CAPABILITY / INTERFACE / RESPONSIBILITY

Before drafting

Is the task scope understandable?

Before review

Are source status and the receiving question visible?

After revision

What changed, and which condition remains open?

Which review point would prevent a meaningful uncertainty from being hidden?

A useful rhythm might include a scope check before drafting, a source-status check before review and a revision check before another decision. Each should answer a specific question.

These are relative review points, not a calendar or a real meeting obligation. More meetings do not automatically create clearer responsibility. Decide what information should trigger a discussion and what can be handled through an appropriate artifact.

Operating rhythm

The model provides no actual meeting dates, response times or service levels. Keep the rhythm adaptable to the task and the relevant access conditions.

09 / OPERATING MODEL

Handle a conflict at the relevant interface.

PROPOSED INTERFACE

4 / reviewer → author

AUTHORITY BOUNDARY

5 interfaces, 4 roles; no appointments or delegated authority.

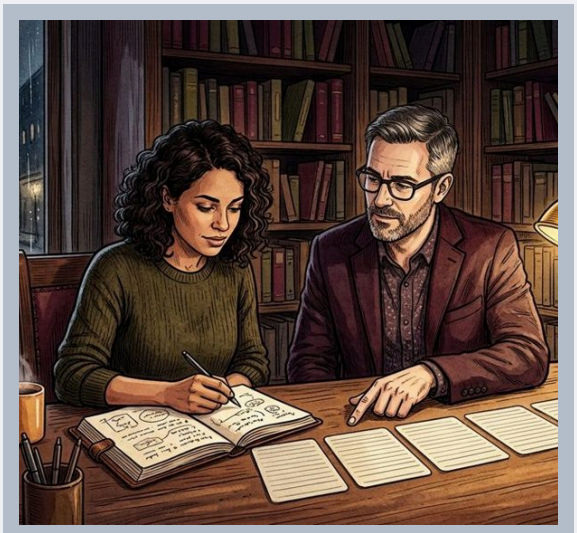


Figure 5 / fictional illustration, not evidence / curated image source in provenance.json

CAPABILITY / INTERFACE / RESPONSIBILITY

Issue

The claim has competing interpretations.

Information needed

Relevant source, version and intended meaning.

Authority gap

No actual escalation or decision route supplied.

Is the conflict about a fact, an interpretation or who may decide?

If the author and reviewer interpret a claim differently, preserve both the question and the relevant source before deciding who should resolve it. Do not let a status label conceal the disagreement.

The model grants no escalation or arbitration power. A real concern needs an appropriate actual route and a clear remit. Distinguish missing information, competing interpretations and a decision that requires authority.

Conflict-handling record

Record the issue at the task level without unnecessary personal information or an assumed judgement about someone’s motives.

10 / OPERATING MODEL

Evolve the model with a visible reason.

PROPOSED INTERFACE

5 / author → owner

AUTHORITY BOUNDARY

5 interfaces, 4 roles; no appointments or delegated authority.

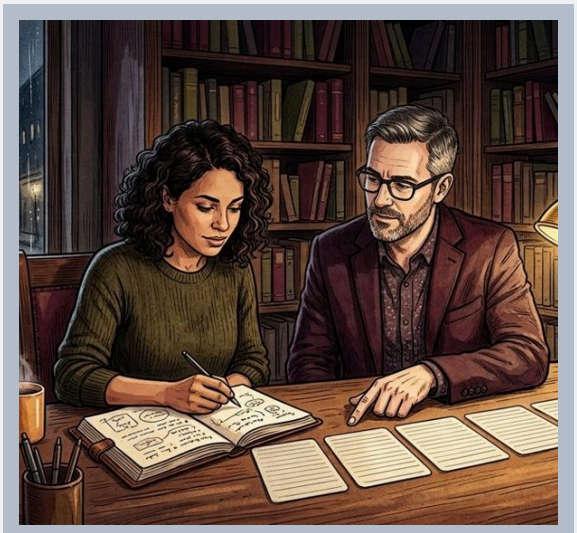


Figure 5 / fictional illustration, not evidence / curated image source in provenance.json

CAPABILITY / INTERFACE / RESPONSIBILITY

Change record

Describe the proposed difference and its task reason.

Continuity check

Preserve the receiving question and responsibility boundary.

Implementation boundary

No real approval, rollout or measured improvement.

What evidence would justify changing this capability or interface?

When an interface changes, record what work moved, why the change was proposed and how responsibility and source context will remain inspectable. Preserve the earlier map for comparison.

This version contains a conceptual loop, not a tested organisational design. No actual performance improvement, governance approval or implemented change is reported. Use appropriate evidence before transferring the proposal into a real setting.

Operating-model revision

A cleaner diagram is not proof of a better system. Review the work and its conditions, not merely the appearance of the model.